ECP172 | Final Past-Paper Study Pack

Exam preparation • 21 October 2026 • Questions followed immediately by bold red model answers

Q1 | Education legislation and policy

Scenario A: The challenges of the implementation of BELA Act

ORIGINAL SCENARIO • 2025 Semester 2, page 3

A Quintile 1 school in a remote rural village in the Eastern Cape is grappling with the complexities of preparing for the implementation of the BELA Act. The school principal conducted a situational analysis and presented the Department of Basic Education with five primary challenges. These are not isolated issues; rather, they are deeply interconnected, revealing a systemic lack of readiness. First, infrastructure is a significant concern. The school lacks any available classrooms for a new Grade R class, and its existing toilets are outdated pit latrines, which are entirely unsuitable for five-year-olds.

Second, access and transportation pose major issues. The villages are dispersed over a 10km radius, with many potential Grade R learners residing more than 5km from the school. Without a viable transportation solution, legal compliance will be a major barrier for many families. Furthermore, parental and community involvement is severely limited. Most parents are unemployed or work as seasonal farm labourers often far from home, resulting in very low attendance at School Governing Body (SGB) meetings. This lack of engagement means that a critical layer of school governance is effectively absent.

These local challenges are compounded by a broader lack of systemic support. The school feels isolated from the District Office, which is over 150km away. Support visits are infrequent, and responses to queries are often delayed for months, leaving the school to navigate the new legal requirements on its own. Taken together, these four challenges illustrate that the successful implementation of the BELA Act in remote rural schools requires more than legal mandate; it demands significant and targeted investment in infrastructure, transportation, and sustained systemic support.

1.1 Explain the purpose of the BELA Act and identify the two Acts it amends. (4 marks) [Predicted]

The BELA Act updates basic education legislation to improve governance, access and accountability (2). It amends the South African Schools Act and the Employment of Educators Act (2).

1.2 Identify FOUR challenges affecting BELA implementation in the scenario. (4 marks) [Predicted]

Inadequate classrooms and unsafe sanitation; long distances and insufficient transport; weak parent/SGB participation; inadequate district support.

1.3 Explain TWO ways the education department could address the school's infrastructure and transport challenges. (4 marks) [Predicted]

Provide suitable Grade R classrooms and safe sanitation facilities (2). Arrange accessible learner transport for children living far from the school (2).

1.4 Discuss THREE responsibilities of the School Governing Body in implementing education policies. (6 marks) [Predicted]

Represent parents and communicate their concerns (2). Participate in developing and reviewing school policies within the law (2). Work with the principal and education department to identify needs and support implementation (2).

1.5 Explain why implementation of the BELA Act should promote educational equity. (3 marks) [Predicted]

Learners should have fair access to basic education regardless of their location or socioeconomic circumstances. Rural learners need adequate facilities, safe access and appropriate support to benefit meaningfully from their rights.

1.6 Explain TWO possible consequences of inadequate district support for the school. (4 marks) [Predicted]

Delayed implementation of Grade R and essential infrastructure improvements (2). Continued inequality because the school lacks guidance, resources and assistance to overcome its challenges (2).

Religion and Education: parental concerns scenario

ORIGINAL SCENARIO • EDSB700 Special Assessment, page 5

You are an educator at a school in the city which has a diverse student body, including religious affiliation, and you have been tasked with teaching the religion studies curriculum in your respective phase of teaching. Numerous parents whose religious views are varied, have raised concerns about the inclusion of religion studies in the school curriculum. They are apprehensive that teaching this curriculum will indoctrinate their children, who they prefer to raise in their own religious belief system.

3.1 Briefly discuss the South African Policy on Religion (2003) and provide an explanation of the difference between religion education and religious education. (5 marks) [Original]

The National Policy on Religion and Education (2003) promotes respect for freedom of religion, diversity and constitutional values in public education. Religion education is educational study ABOUT religions, beliefs and their social/cultural roles, without seeking conversion. Religious education is instruction WITHIN a particular faith to nurture adherence to that faith. A public-school teacher must not indoctrinate learners.

3.2 Clarify the relationship between religion and education by discussing the four possible models for structuring the relationship between religion and the state as per the Policy on Religion and Education (2003). (12 marks) [Original]

Four broad models: (1) Theocratic/religious state: one religion strongly determines state policy. (2) State religion: an official religion receives special state recognition or preference. (3) Strict separation/secular exclusion: religion is largely excluded from public state institutions. (4) Cooperative or impartial accommodation: the democratic state protects freedom of belief, treats religions fairly and permits educational study of religions without favouring one. Explain the consequences of each for equal learner rights. NOTE: Confirm the exact FOUR model labels against your prescribed course notes; this is a study explanation, not a verified verbatim classification from the policy.

3.3 Justify the model that provides the best framework for religion and education in democratic South Africa. (3 marks) [Original]

An impartial, rights-based approach best supports South Africa's Constitution because it protects freedom of religion and conscience, respects religious diversity and avoids state or teacher indoctrination. Learners can study religions fairly while retaining their own beliefs.

3.4 Explain how you would respond to the parents' concerns, considering your personal beliefs and your role as an educator. Give a phase-specific example. (5 marks) [Original]

I would explain that religion education teaches ABOUT different belief systems; it does not ask learners to practise or adopt a religion. My personal beliefs must not influence assessment or favouritism. I would share the curriculum and invite respectful discussion. In Senior Phase Social Sciences, for example, learners could compare the cultural significance of different religious celebrations using neutral sources, with equal respect for non-religious learners.

Q2 | Research in education

Cyberbullying research: original Quote B

ORIGINAL SOURCE ABSTRACT • 2025 Semester 2, page 5

Background: The overwhelming use of Internet and social media among the youth in South Africa causes both negative and positive effects on the users. Cyberbullying is one manifestation of such negative effects. Rural high school students are not immune to this modern age social problem. To protect them against the possible hazards, it is important to study this phenomenon among this group of young people.

Objectives: This study explored the extent of the use of Internet and social media, the forms and frequency of cyberbullying and their effects on the emotional well-being and academic performance of grades 8–10 students in a rural high school in Limpopo, South Africa.

Method: This study used a mixed research approach. Eighty participants consisting of 50 females and 30 males from grades 8 to 10 in a rural high school participated in this

survey and 6 purposefully selected victims of cyberbullying completed an interview schedule.

Results: The majority of participants had access to cyber technology and used Facebook frequently. More than half of the participants experienced a wide variety of cyberbullying, sexual offence being the highest. They were negatively affected both emotionally and academically to the extent that some thought of suicide.

Conclusion: Even though students in this rural high school have access to the latest cyber technology, they are not equipped to prevent or cope with its negative effects; hence, they suffer in solitude. The study recommends an anti-cyberbullying policy being established, as well as counselling at school, and advises stakeholders who intend to expand e-learning at schools to include cyber safety and supportive mechanisms in their programmes for successful implementation.

Source: Farhangpour, P., Maluleke, C. & Mutshaeni, H.N. (2019). Emotional and academic effects of cyberbullying on students in a rural high school in the Limpopo province, South Africa. South African Journal of Information Management, 21(1).

2.1 What is the title of the study? (2 marks) [Original]

Emotional and academic effects of cyberbullying on students in a rural high school in the Limpopo province, South Africa.

2.2 Identify and define the research approach used in the study and explain why this approach was the most suitable for this study. (6 marks: 2 + 2 + 2) [Original]

Approach: mixed-methods research (2). Definition: combines quantitative numerical data with qualitative descriptive accounts in one study (2). Suitability: the survey measures prevalence and patterns while interviews explore victims' emotional and academic experiences in depth (2).

2.3.1 Develop a research question and one secondary question. (4 marks) [Original]

Main question: How does cyberbullying affect the emotional well-being and academic performance of Grades 8–10 learners at a rural Limpopo high school?

Secondary question: What forms of cyberbullying do these learners experience most frequently?

2.3.2 What is the aim of the study? (2 marks) [Original]

To investigate the prevalence and forms of cyberbullying and examine their effects on the emotional well-being and academic performance of Grades 8–10 learners at a rural high school in Limpopo.

2.4.1 How was data collected? (2 marks) [Original]

Through a survey of 80 Grade 8–10 learners and interviews with six purposefully selected cyberbullying victims.

2.4.2 Describe the two data collection tools used to collect data. (4 marks: 2 + 2) [Original]

Survey questionnaire: standardised questions completed by 80 learners to collect comparable information about internet use and cyberbullying. Interview schedule: prepared guiding questions used with six victims to gather detailed personal experiences.

2.5.1 Discuss THREE key ethical considerations before researching minors about cyberbullying. (6 marks: 2 + 2 + 2) [Original]

1. Informed consent and assent: obtain appropriate parent/guardian permission and learners' voluntary agreement. 2. Confidentiality and privacy: anonymise responses and store sensitive data securely. 3. Protection from harm: avoid retraumatisation, allow withdrawal and arrange referral/support if distress or risk is disclosed. Follow school and institutional ethics approval requirements.

Question 6 – Research in Education -Methodology (25 marks)

ORIGINAL QUOTE D • 2025 Main Examination, page 9

A research methodology is a systematic way to solve research problems. It is a science of understanding how research is conducted methodically by applying correct procedures that enable the researcher to determine solutions to an existing problem.

Source: Lecturer's own comment.

6.1 What is academic research? (2 marks) [Original]

A systematic, ethical investigation that gathers and analyses evidence to answer a research question or develop knowledge.

6.2 Describe the difference between a research introduction and the problem statement. (4 marks: 2 + 2) [Original]

Introduction: provides background, context and why the topic matters. Problem statement: precisely identifies the specific gap, difficulty or issue the study will investigate.

6.3 Why do academic researchers do research? (6 marks: 2 + 2 + 2) [Original]

To generate or test knowledge; to understand and explain real-world educational problems; and to produce evidence that informs interventions, policy and better teaching practice.

6.4 Which research approach may be more appealing to you? Justify your response. (4 marks: 2 + 2) [Original]

I would choose mixed methods (2) because numerical surveys show how widespread cyberbullying is, while interviews explain how it affects individual learners (2).

6.5 Depending on that choice, which data collection method would you use? Justify. (3 marks: 1 + 2) [Original]

A questionnaire plus semi-structured interviews (1). Questionnaires provide comparable patterns, and interviews give detailed explanations of learners' experiences (2).

6.6 Describe a data analysis tool you know and its application. (6 marks: 2 + 2 + 2) [Original]

Microsoft Excel: (1) enter and organise questionnaire data in a spreadsheet; (2) calculate frequencies, percentages and summary statistics; (3) create charts to

compare reported cyberbullying patterns. Interview responses can separately be coded using thematic analysis.

Question 6 – Data collection methods (25 marks)

ORIGINAL RESOURCE E • EDSB700 Special Assessment, page 8

Primary data collection methods are techniques and procedures used to gather information for research purposes. These methods can range from, simple self-reported surveys, to more complex experiments, and can involve either quantitative or qualitative approaches to data gathering. Source: Lecturer's own comment.

6.1 Describe the qualitative data collection methods: individual interviews, observations and focus group discussions. (9 marks: 3 + 3 + 3) [Original]

Individual interviews: one-to-one guided conversations that explore a participant's views and experiences. Observations: systematically watching and recording behaviour or events in a natural or structured setting. Focus groups: facilitated discussions with several participants that explore shared and differing perspectives through interaction.

6.2 Discuss the advantages of each data collection method. (6 marks: 2 + 2 + 2) [Original]

Interviews: rich personal detail; opportunity to probe and clarify. Observations: reveal actual behaviour; capture context that participants might omit. Focus groups: collect diverse views efficiently; interaction can generate new insights.

6.3 Discuss the disadvantages of each data collection method. (6 marks: 2 + 2 + 2) [Original]

Interviews: time-consuming; participants may give socially desirable answers. Observations: observer bias/reactivity; difficult to infer motives. Focus groups: dominant participants can silence others; confidentiality cannot be fully guaranteed among group members.

6.4 Demonstrate critical discussion of when each method is appropriate. (4 marks) [Original assessment criterion, converted to study prompt]

Use interviews when sensitive individual experiences require privacy; observations when classroom practices must be seen directly; focus groups when group norms and varied viewpoints matter. In cyberbullying research, private interviews are safer for victims, while focus groups may discourage disclosure because peers are present.

Q3 | Language of learning, teaching and support

Question 3 – Policies of Teaching and Learning (25 marks)

ORIGINAL SCENARIO C • 2025 Semester 2, pages 6–7

The language of education is arguably a very powerful obstacle to the educational achievement of bilingual learners in their quest to learn through the medium of English in a bilingual classroom. Among the challenges are inadequate training on the part of teachers to identify and correct learners' grammatical errors. This could be remedied if English is taught by qualified language teachers, instead of allocating language teaching to any non-language specialist. Having little or no training means that teachers often lack opportunities to gain competence in the Language of Learning and Teaching (LoLT). The majority of teachers in the district who participated in the study are themselves second-language speakers of English who, by their own admission, lack knowledge and competence in grammar.

Source: Makhathini, F.N& Mncwango, E.N. 2020. Challenges with the teaching of English Language in a Bilingual Classroom, A Journal of Contemporary Research, 17(2), 71-85.

The relationship of the LoLT and the SIAS policy. The systemic challenges of LoLT are not confined to mainstream education; it also poses a major threat to the objectives of critical policies like the Screening, Identification, Assessment, and Support (SIAS) policy. SIAS is designed to ensure that all learners with barriers to learning are identified and supported. However, when a teacher lacks the grammatical competence to distinguish between a language acquisition error and a genuine learning difficulty, they may fail to correctly identify a learner who needs specialised support. In such cases, a student with a specific language-based barrier (such as dyslexia) might be misidentified as merely "grammatically incompetent," undermining the very purpose of the SIAS framework and highlighting how teacher competence is

a fundamental prerequisite for effective inclusive education.

Source: Lecturer's own comment

3.2.1 Define the SIAS policy and any THREE core objectives. (4 marks: 1 + 3) [Original]

SIAS means Screening, Identification, Assessment and Support: a policy process for identifying and addressing barriers to learning (1). Objectives: identify support needs early; determine appropriate levels of support and interventions; promote equitable access, participation and inclusion for learners (3).

3.2.2 Explain ANY SIX responsibilities of teachers in the SIAS process. (12 marks: 6 + 6) [Original]

1. Screen learners for barriers and strengths; explain what evidence is observed. 2. Gather information from learning tasks and assessment; distinguish language acquisition from disability. 3. Consult learners and parents sensitively; obtain useful contextual information. 4. Implement classroom-level support and differentiated teaching; record what works. 5. Complete relevant SIAS documentation and refer unresolved needs to the School-Based Support Team (SBST). 6. Monitor progress, review support plans and collaborate with the SBST/district when more support is required. Each responsibility should be explained, not merely named.

The source paper labels these as 3.2.1 and 3.2.2 and does not visibly allocate the remaining nine marks to an additional subquestion. The practice questions below cover the scenario without inventing an "original" 25-mark allocation.

PRACTICE: Why can limited English proficiency be mistaken for a learning disability? (4 suggested marks)

A learner still acquiring English may make grammar or comprehension errors despite understanding content in a home language. If a teacher interprets these errors as a disability without multilingual assessment, the learner may be incorrectly labelled or referred. Assess in accessible language and use SIAS evidence before deciding on support.

PRACTICE: Suggest classroom responses to the LoLT problem. (4 suggested marks)

Pre-teach subject vocabulary; use visuals and concrete examples; allow purposeful home-language explanations/code-switching; use formative checks and scaffolded writing. Strengthen teacher language competence through professional development.

Question 3 – English as a Language of Teaching and Learning (25 marks)

ORIGINAL SCENARIO C • 2025 Main Examination, page 5

Ms. Phindi teaches a Grade 5 class in a diverse South African school. Her class includes learners who speak Sesotho, IsiZulu, Xhosa, Sepedi, Afrikaans, and English as their home languages. While the school's Language in Education Policy (LIEP) promotes additive multilingualism, Ms. Zama faces several challenges. Many learners struggle with English, the Language of Learning and Teaching (LOLT), impacting their comprehension of other subjects.

Resources for supporting diverse language needs are limited, and parental involvement is inconsistent due to varying levels of literacy and socioeconomic factors. Furthermore, some learners feel marginalized because their home languages are not adequately acknowledged or celebrated in the classroom. Ms. Zama is committed to creating an inclusive learning environment, but she feels overwhelmed by the complexity of addressing these language issues.

The original paper asked for an essay on LiEP, LAC, equity, resources, parents and teacher training. These are PRACTICE structured questions with suggested marks.

3.1 Define LoLT, LiEP and LAC. (6 marks) [Practice]

LoLT: the language used to teach, learn and assess subjects. LiEP: Language in Education Policy, which supports language rights and additive multilingualism. LAC: Language Across the Curriculum, meaning every subject teacher develops learners' reading, writing, speaking and subject vocabulary.

3.2 Identify FOUR challenges in the scenario. (4 marks) [Practice]

English comprehension difficulties; limited multilingual teaching resources; inconsistent parental involvement; learners' home languages being marginalised.

3.3 Explain additive multilingualism and why it matters. (3 marks) [Practice]

Additive multilingualism develops additional languages while maintaining and valuing the home language. It strengthens identity, participation and learning rather than replacing learners' existing linguistic resources.

3.4 Recommend FOUR inclusive teaching strategies. (4 marks) [Practice]

Use bilingual vocabulary lists; scaffold English with diagrams and examples; permit structured peer discussion in home languages; explicitly teach language skills and subject terminology in every lesson.

3.5 Explain the roles of resources, parents and teacher development. (6 marks) [Practice]

Resources: provide multilingual texts, visuals and accessible learning materials (2). Parents: invite home-language support and communicate accessibly without assuming high literacy (2). Teacher development: improve teachers' English proficiency, multilingual strategies and inclusive assessment (2).

3.6 Explain how language practices affect educational equity. (2 marks) [Practice]

Learners who cannot access the LoLT may understand the subject but fail to demonstrate knowledge. Inclusive language support gives them fairer opportunities to participate and succeed.

Q4 | Multicultural education: theory only

NO SCENARIOS OR ESSAYS IN THIS SECTION. The past papers offer few directly matching standalone multicultural-theory questions. Questions explicitly marked "Practice" are based on the confirmed revision topics, not copied from past papers.

Define discrimination. (2 marks) [Original standalone question, 2025 Semester 2 Q4]

Unfair treatment of a person or group based on characteristics such as race, gender, religion, disability or sexual orientation, resulting in unequal opportunities or harm.

What is one intervention strategy school management can use to address discrimination? (1 mark) [Original standalone question, 2025 Semester 2 Q4]

Implement and consistently enforce an anti-discrimination policy supported by reporting procedures and staff/learner education.

Define multicultural education. (2 marks) [Practice]

An educational approach that recognises cultural diversity and aims to provide equitable learning opportunities, respect and inclusion for learners from all cultural backgrounds.

State FOUR goals of multicultural education. (4 marks) [Practice]

Promote equality and educational access; respect diverse cultures and identities; reduce prejudice and discrimination; develop democratic participation and intercultural understanding.

Name Banks' FOUR approaches to multicultural curriculum reform. (4 marks) [Practice]

Contributions approach; additive approach; transformation approach; social action approach.

Explain the contributions approach. (2 marks) [Practice]

Include cultural heroes, celebrations and special events without changing the underlying curriculum structure; for example, marking Heritage Day.

Explain the additive approach. (2 marks) [Practice]

Add cultural content, texts or perspectives to existing lessons while retaining the original curriculum structure; for example, including a local history unit.

Explain the transformation approach. (2 marks) [Practice]

Restructure teaching so learners examine topics through multiple cultural perspectives rather than treating one viewpoint as the default.

Explain the social action approach. (2 marks) [Practice]

Learners investigate a social justice issue, make informed decisions and take appropriate action, such as planning a school anti-discrimination campaign.

Distinguish equality from equity. (4 marks) [Practice]

Equality means giving everyone the same treatment or resources. Equity means providing fair, responsive support according to differing needs so learners have meaningful opportunities to succeed.

Distinguish prejudice, stereotype and discrimination. (3 marks) [Practice]

Stereotype: oversimplified generalisation about a group. Prejudice: preconceived attitude or judgement. Discrimination: unfair action or treatment based on such beliefs.

What is cultural interaction in a multicultural classroom? (2 marks) [Practice]

Respectful engagement between learners with different cultural backgrounds, involving dialogue, cooperation and learning from diverse perspectives.

Give THREE ways to promote positive cultural interaction. (3 marks) [Practice]

Use mixed-group cooperative learning; include multiple cultural perspectives in examples and texts; establish discussion rules that protect respect and challenge stereotypes.

What is prejudice reduction? (2 marks) [Practice]

Teaching strategies that challenge stereotypes and negative attitudes and help learners develop more respectful views of different groups.

What is equity pedagogy? (2 marks) [Practice]

Adapting teaching methods and assessment to support achievement by learners from diverse cultural, linguistic and social backgrounds.

Explain the difference between assimilation and multicultural inclusion. (4 marks) [Practice]

Assimilation expects minority learners to adopt the dominant culture and suppress differences. Multicultural inclusion values diverse identities and adapts schooling so learners can participate without abandoning their cultural backgrounds.

Why should a teacher avoid imposing personal religious or cultural beliefs? (2 marks) [Practice]

Teachers have a professional duty to respect learners' rights, promote fairness and prevent indoctrination or discrimination in a diverse classroom.

END OF STUDY PACK • Prioritise understanding and applying the answers, rather than memorising scenario wording.